Deeper Issues

A Checklist of Core Beliefs

Check any thought that occurs often, or that you strongly believe.

Name: _____ **Date:** _____

Fairness, Control & Perfectionism

- ☐ Life should be fair
- ☐ Things should always go my way
- ☐ I must be perfect
- ☐ I should know everything
- ☐ I should always be happy
- ☐ I must always be productive
- ☐ I need to control everything to feel safe
- ☐ I have to be prepared for the worst
- ☐ I can't stand uncertainty
- ☐ I'm overwhelmed by uncertainty
- ☐ I can't say “no”
- ☐ I'm always right

Failure & Incompetence

- ☐ I'm a failure
- ☐ I'm a complete failure
- ☐ I'm doomed to fail
- ☐ I'm a fraud (impostor syndrome)
- ☐ I'm stupid
- ☐ I'm stupid and always will be
- ☐ I can't do anything right
- ☐ I always mess things up
- ☐ I can never seem to accomplish anything
- ☐ I haven't done anything with my life
- ☐ I'm a loser
- ☐ I can't seem to get going in my life

Trust, Safety & Suspicion

- ☐ I can't trust anyone
- ☐ You can't trust anyone
- ☐ I can't trust my own judgment
- ☐ My world isn't safe
- ☐ Everyone's out to get me
- ☐ Everyone is judging me
- ☐ I'm always being watched
- ☐ People are taking advantage of me
- ☐ I'm always the victim
- ☐ Things like this always happen to me
- ☐ I always have bad luck

Worth & Self-Image

- ☐ I'm unworthy
- ☐ I'm inferior
- ☐ I'm inferior to others
- ☐ My worth depends on others' approval
- ☐ I don't deserve happiness
- ☐ I'm not worthy of happiness
- ☐ I don't deserve success
- ☐ I'm ugly
- ☐ I don't like myself
- ☐ I'm worthless
- ☐ I'm no good, I never have been

Isolation & Feeling Unloved

- ☐ I'm a burden to others
- ☐ I'm a bother to others
- ☐ I'm alone in my struggles
- ☐ I'm destined to be alone
- ☐ No one cares about me
- ☐ No one understands me
- ☐ Nobody understands me
- ☐ Nobody could possibly like me
- ☐ Nobody loves me
- ☐ I'm always disappointing others
- ☐ I never have any luck with men/women
- ☐ I'll never find love

Powerlessness & Resistance to Change

- ☐ I can't change
- ☐ I'm incapable of change
- ☐ I'm powerless to change
- ☐ I'll never change
- ☐ I'm powerless
- ☐ I'm helpless
- ☐ I'm totally helpless
- ☐ I can't handle rejection
- ☐ I can't handle conflict
- ☐ He/she will never change
- ☐ You can't teach an old dog new tricks
- ☐ I'm weak for seeking help

Deeper Issues

A Checklist of Core Beliefs

(continued)

Hopelessness About the Future

- ☐ My situation is hopeless
- ☐ Nothing ever changes
- ☐ Things will never get better
- ☐ I'll never get better
- ☐ I'll never recover
- ☐ I'll never get over this
- ☐ I'll never get well
- ☐ The future looks black
- ☐ There's no use trying, I'll only fail again
- ☐ There's no way out of this situation
- ☐ I'm doomed
- ☐ There's nothing I can do, I've tried everything

Despair & Giving Up

- ☐ I'll never be happy
- ☐ There's nothing to be happy about
- ☐ I can't go on
- ☐ I can't go on like this
- ☐ I give up
- ☐ I can't stand it any longer
- ☐ I'm so weak I can hardly go on
- ☐ My life's a total disaster
- ☐ The world is full of misery
- ☐ There's nothing good in this world, it's entirely sinful
- ☐ It would be better if I were dead

Guilt & Shame

- ☐ It's all my fault
- ☐ I've done something terrible that I shouldn't have
- ☐ I've let someone down
- ☐ I've committed a terrible and unforgivable act
- ☐ I'm a bad person
- ☐ I can't stand the shame of it
- ☐ I can't tell anyone, I'm too ashamed
- ☐ No one really understands how bad things are for me

Spiritual Despair

- ☐ God has forsaken me
- ☐ I pray, but God doesn't answer
- ☐ My sins are unforgivable
- ☐ I'm going to hell
- ☐ God will punish me
- ☐ There must not be a God

Anxiety & Worry

- ☐ I can't stop worrying
- ☐ I'm afraid of the future
- ☐ I dread what might happen
- ☐ The worst will probably happen
- ☐ This is the worst thing that could possibly happen
- ☐ I can't handle anxiety
- ☐ I'm anxious about being anxious
- ☐ I must avoid anything that makes me anxious
- ☐ I can't cope with stress
- ☐ I'm afraid of losing control
- ☐ There's too much to do, the work is overwhelming

Overwhelm, Control & Mind

- ☐ I've lost control of my life
- ☐ I'm out of control
- ☐ I'm losing my mind
- ☐ I can't control my thoughts
- ☐ I can't concentrate
- ☐ I can't express my emotions
- ☐ I'll never be able to make it financially
- ☐ It's too hard, it's not worth the effort
- ☐ The pain is unbearable
- ☐ I don't have the energy anymore
- ☐ I'll never be good enough

Of the items you checked, which 3–5 feel most true or trouble you the most?

Checking a statement does not mean it is irrational or that it causes your feelings — it simply helps identify thoughts worth exploring further with your counselor. If you are having thoughts of harming yourself, please reach out right away: call or text 988 (Suicide & Crisis Lifeline), available 24/7. You don't have to carry this alone.